

Amazon Interview Handbook

1. Company Overview

Amazon is a global technology giant focused on e-commerce, cloud computing (AWS), and artificial intelligence. Its culture is famously driven by 16 Leadership Principles (LPs).

2. Hiring Process (2025-2026)

The process is highly standardized and focuses equally on technical skills and Leadership Principles:

- **Online Assessment (OA):** 2-3 coding problems + behavioral survey.
- **Technical Phone Screen:** 45-60 mins focusing on DSA and 1-2 LPs.
- **The Loop (Onsite):** 4-5 rounds (60 mins each):
 - **Coding Rounds (2-3):** DSA with 20-30 mins dedicated to LPs.
 - **System Design (1):** High-level architecture (for SDE II+).
 - **Bar Raiser (1):** An external interviewer focused on cultural fit and LPs.

3. Leadership Principles (The Core of Amazon)

Amazon evaluates every candidate against its 16 Leadership Principles. You must have 2 STAR stories for each.

- **Customer Obsession:** Starting with the customer and working backwards.
- **Ownership:** Thinking long-term and never saying “that’s not my job.”
- **Bias for Action:** Speed matters; many decisions are reversible.
- **Dive Deep:** Staying connected to details and auditing frequently.
- **Have Backbone; Disagree and Commit:** Challenging decisions respectfully.

4. Data Structures & Algorithms (DSA)

Frequently Asked Problems

Topic	Problem Example	Difficulty
Trees/Graphs	Number of Islands, Word Ladder	Medium/Hard
Arrays/Strings	Two Sum, LRU Cache	Medium
Dynamic Programming	Coin Change, Longest Palindromic Substring	Medium
Sorting/Searching	Kth Largest Element in an Array	Medium

5. Machine Learning (ML) & AI System Design

ML Questions

- **Foundations:** Logistic Regression vs. SVM, Random Forest vs. XGBoost.
- **AWS SageMaker:** Familiarity with Amazon's ML platform is a plus.
- **Generative AI:** Designing scalable RAG pipelines, LLM fine-tuning on AWS.

AI System Design

- **Recommendation Engines:** Design the "Customers who bought this also bought" feature.
- **Search Ranking:** Designing product search ranking for Amazon.com.
- **Fraud Detection:** Real-time fraud detection for payments.

6. System Design

- **Topics:** Load Balancers, S3, DynamoDB, Lambda, Microservices.
- **Common Questions:** Design a URL Shortener, Design an E-commerce Checkout System, Design a Distributed Cache.

7. Behavioral Questions (STAR Method)

- "Tell me about a time you went above and beyond for a customer." (Customer Obsession)

- “Tell me about a time you took a calculated risk.” (Bias for Action)
- “Tell me about a time you had a conflict with a manager.” (Have Backbone)

8. Online Assessment (OA)

- **Part 1:** Coding (2 questions, 70 mins).
- **Part 2:** Work Simulation (situational judgment).
- **Part 3:** Self-Assessment (behavioral).

9. References

- [Amazon Leadership Principles](#)
- [I Got An Offer - Amazon Interview Questions](#)
- [TryExponent - Amazon Interview Guide](#)